Wooseong Yang

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SUMMARY

PhD student at UIC | Industry research collaborator at W.W. Grainger | LLM agents, RAG, recommender systems | Available for internship: Spring 2027 – Fall 2027 (Jan – Dec 2027)

EDUCATION

University of Illinois at Chicago (UIC) — *Ph.D. in Computer Science (Advisor: Prof. **Philip S. Yu**)* Aug 2023 – (May 2028)

University of Texas at Dallas (UTD) — *M.S. in Computer Science (Advisor: Prof. **Latifur Khan**)* Aug 2021 – Aug 2023

- *Thesis: Pre-trained Spanish Language Model for Political Conflict and Violence*

Carnegie Mellon University (CMU) — *Visiting Scholar at LTI (Director: Prof. **Jamie Callan**)* Jan 2020 – Jul 2020

Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU) — *M.S. in Industrial Engineering (Advisor: Prof. **Mye Sohn**)* Mar 2019 – Feb 2021

- *Thesis: Cross-domain Knowledge Transfer for Session-based Recommender Systems*

Sungkyunkwan University (SKKU) — *B.S. in Systems Management Engineering* Mar 2013 – Feb 2019

SELECTED PUBLICATIONS

XBridge: Entity-Grounded Latent Bridge for Heterogeneous LLM Communication | ***Wooseong Yang**, Wei-Chieh Huang, Weizhi Zhang, Yu Wang, Philip S. Yu, Junhyun Lee* | *NeurIPS 2026 (Travel Award)*

Rethinking Semantic ID Construction for Generative Recommendation: SimHash with Parallel Decoding and Semantic Alignment | *Yuqing Liu, Huiyuan Chen, Yibo Wang, **Wooseong Yang**, Philip S. Yu* | *NeurIPS 2026*

Adaptive Candidate Retrieval with Dynamic Knowledge Graph Construction for Cold-Start Recommendation | ***Wooseong Yang**, Weizhi Zhang, Yuqing Liu, Yuwei Han, Yu Wang, Junhyun Lee, Philip S. Yu* | *arXiv 2026 (Under Review)*

A Survey of Agent Memory in the Second Half: Towards Self-Evolving and Long-Horizon Agents | *Wei-Chieh Huang, Weizhi Zhang, Yueqing Liang, **Wooseong Yang**, Philip S. Yu, et al.* | *TMLR 2026*

RECODE-H: A Benchmark for Research Code DEvelopment with Interactive Human Feedback | *Chunyu Miao, Henry Peng Zou, Yanning Li, Yankai Chen, Yibo Wang, Fangxin Wang, Yifan Li, **Wooseong Yang**, Philip S. Yu, et al.* | *ICLR 2026*

Subgraph-level Universal Prompt Tuning | *Junhyun Lee, **Wooseong Yang**, Jaewoo Kang* | *Information Sciences 2026*

LLMInit: A Free Lunch from Large Language Models for Selective Initialization of Recommendation | *Weizhi Zhang, Liangwei Yang, **Wooseong Yang**, Henry Peng Zou, Yuqing Liu, Ke Xu, Sourav Medya, Philip S. Yu* | *EMNLP Industry 2025*

Cluster-aware Item Prompt Learning for Session-based Recommendation | ***Wooseong Yang**, Chen Wang, Zihe Song, Weizhi Zhang, Philip S. Yu* | *IEEE BigData 2025*

Toward User Preference Alignment in LLM Recommendation via Explicit Context Feedback | *Weizhi Zhang*, **Wooseong Yang***, Yuxin Cui, Zhaohui Guo, Hins Hu, Liangwei Yang, Philip S. Yu, et al.* | *IEEE CogMI 2025 (*equal contribution)*

ONGOING RESEARCH & INDUSTRY PROJECTS

Agentic Knowledge Graph Reasoning for Retrieval-Augmented Recommendation | *Mar 2026 – Present*

- RL-based agentic KG reasoning to extract relevant evidence for LLM-based recommendation.

Retrieval-Augmented Generation for Industrial Product Search | *Jan 2026 – Present*

- Industry collaboration with **W.W. Grainger, Inc.** (Fortune 500); PIs: Prof. **Moontae Lee** and Prof. **Theja Tulabandhula**. Designing RAG pipelines and analyzing industrial product documents for large-scale catalog search.

ACADEMIC ACTIVITIES

[Reviewer] Conferences |

- KDD 2024–2027 (multiple cycles); WSDM 2027; ICLR 2027; ARR October 2026; WWW 2025; RecSys 2024

SKILLS

Programming languages: Python, Java, C++, MATLAB | ML frameworks: PyTorch, TensorFlow, HuggingFace Transformers | LLM & RAG: LangChain, vLLM, FAISS | Languages: English, Korean